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Creative Outlier Air

A solid competitor in the sub-10K price range



Price
₹6,999

Audio veteran company, Creative, has been revered in the audio industry for its sound cards and desktop speakers. Here, we are reviewing the the Creative Outlier Air true wireless earphones, which on paper, pushes the boundaries of what is usually expected from a relatively affordable pair of true wireless earbuds. So, let's find out if it translates well in real-life usage.



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Featuring an obloid-ish shape, the charging case can be opened by pushing one end which reveals a slide-out tray for the earphones to dock into. The case also houses a USB-C charging port and four LED indicators.

Features

Powered by Bluetooth v5.0, the Creative Outlier Air boasts solid wireless connectivity. One without any lags and stutters in the audio or media. The earphones also support high-quality audio codecs such as AAC and aptX, which not only reduce latency but also improve the overall sound quality. They also come equipped with voice assistant support via the controls.

Now, moving on to one of the most lucrative features of the Creative Outlier Air – the battery life. The earphones' battery life is rated at a whopping 30 hours in total, with 10 hours of continuous playtime on the buds themselves. In our tests, we recorded 8 hours and 20 minutes of playtime on the buds, which is under the company claim, but is still impressive.

Performance

Sporting 5.6mm graphene-coated drivers, the Creative Outlier Air certainly has an 'oomph' in their sound while still keeping all the frequencies relatively balanced and under control. There's a slight bass bias in the sound that can be felt in tracks such as *Pull Me Under* by *Dream Theatre*. The drums in the track slightly overpower lead

instruments and vocals, and there's slight auditory masking in the mids.

Nevertheless, this is us being extremely nitpicky. The mid-highs are also slightly elevated which enhances the clarity of high-frequency instruments and most female vocals. There's also a marked improvement when using aptX over AAC.

The sense of instrumental separation and the reproduction of three-dimensional space is also excellent on these earphones, which isn't surprising considering that Creative did bring us the acclaimed Super X-Fi amplifier and the SXFI technology.

The microphone, on the other hand, is mediocre at best, and earphones from Sony and even IMORE at this price point do a slightly better job at picking up your voice and relaying it accurately on phone calls.

Bottomline

Setting aside some issues with the physical controls, the Creative Outlier Air impressed us in most aspects and ticks a whole lots of boxes for what we'd consider a solid pair of true wireless earphones. Priced at ₹6,999, these earphones are relatively affordable and offer solid sound quality, good battery life, excellent instrument separation, and support for the AAC and aptX audio codecs. These earphones do compete with another solid true wireless earphone, the IMORE Stylish True Wireless, in this price range but the better battery life as well as USB-C charging gives the Outlier Air the edge. So, it's easy to recommend these wireless earphones under 10K.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

BLUETOOTH: v5.0 | WEIGHT: Charging Case: 54g, Earbuds: 2 x 5g | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20-20,000 Hz | DRIVER: 5.6 mm graphene driver diaphragm | BATTERY CHARGING TIME: 1-2 hours | BATTERY LIFE: 10 hours from the earbuds + 20 hours from the charging case | BLUETOOTH OPERATING FREQUENCY: 2.4 GHz | AUDIO CODEC: aptX, AAC, SBC | OPERATING RANGE: Up to 10m / 33 ft | WEARING STYLE: In-ear, True Wireless | MICROPHONE: Frequency Response: 100-10,000 Hz | SENSITIVITY: -42 dBV / Pa | WEATHER-PROOF RESISTANT: IPX5

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Build and comfort

Featuring an eggshell-like finish, the Outlier Air earphones are all matte-black buds with a circular LED light on the back panels. The buds have a rounded, dome-like shape and they're also considerably bulky. They have a pretty decent fit owing to the sharply-angled ear nozzles. The on-board controls are situated inside the LED light ring. Creative has opted for physical buttons, which are, sadly, quite hard to press on these earphones.

The earphones are lightweight and fit comfortably within the ear. They do come with IPX5 water resistance, so if you can use them while working out. There are, however, no fins or wings provided to further aid in stabilisation.

Finally, moving on the charging case, the Outlier Air has an impressively built metal charging case sporting a gunmetal grey shade. Now, the case is definitely on the bulkier side when it comes to dimensions but it is still surprisingly lightweight.